

GELID GX-7 CPU cooler

GELID solutions has announced the GX-7 CPU cooler for its GAMER series product line with 7 power heat pipes



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Cabinet Test

Zebronics Fantasy

The glossy red surface is a surefire dust magnet. The front frame has a slide mechanism to reveal the connecting ports. The lower half has a mesh opening for air intake with a triangular power button upfront. The side panel is transparent and has one 120mm and one 80mm fan. The PSU is mounted on the top. We noticed that once you add an ATX cabinet it leaves very little space to manoeuvre around. The fixed HDD bay tray doesn't help matters when you want to add in a longer graphics card.



ePRO Dragon

the 5.25-inch bays. The side panel has a transparent window with provision to add a 120mm fan. The side panel is very weak, as in it easily bends on applying minimal pressure. The HDD and ODD bays have a tool-less design, and there's around 90-95 mm free space between the motherboard edge and the HDD bay frame. We were surprised to find no rear fan.

NZXT Source 210

The Source 210 Elite looks fleetingly like the H2 thanks to the front frame jutting out from the plane of the frame. The ports are located at the top edge. There are slits around the front portion for ventilation and the entire frame can be detached to add two fans at the front. On the top, there's a provision to add two fans.

The side panel doesn't have any fan but you can add one 120 mm fan. Inside the cabinet there's sufficient space to move around even after adding an ATX board. The motherboard tray is quite sturdy and there's enough space to manage the wires between the right side panel and the board tray.

Considering the board has just one rear fan, you'll need to invest in additional fans if you want a cooler system. It's great for amateur case modders as there's ample scope to experiment with fans.

Circle Polar

The front frame has a glossy exterior along with recessed

optical drive bay and connecting ports located in the front. On the inner side of the side panels you'll find 0.5cm thick sound dampening foam. The base and top portions also have these sound dampening foams. This case is targeted at those users who want an extremely silent system.

The HDD bay is removable and there's sufficient space within the cabinet for wire management. There are dedicated dust filters on the base of the cabinet.

Cooler Master USP 100

The logo in the lower half of the cabinet also functions as the power button. The mesh appearance is maintained from top to bottom for optimal ventilation. There's a dust filter on the inner side of the mesh. The ports are located on the top with a slightly depressed top portion to have a portable HDD.

The side panels of the cabinet have an option for two intake fans. The base of the cabinet has anti-vibration pads for the PSU. There are enough wire management options with dedicated U-shaped plastic cable management clips located just on the periphery of the motherboard tray.

Circle Volcano

Volcano's whole front frame is detachable and doesn't have any dust filters on the inside. The connection ports (USB 2, USB 3 and eSATA) are located on the top of the cabinet just behind the power button and under a slide door.

The presence of green coloured anti-vibration rings is quite a good feature as it prevents HDDs and ODDs from unnecessary vibrations. The USB 3.0 wire must be con-

nected to the USB 3.0 port on the motherboard back I/O panel. Overall it has a pleasant design inside.

Antec Sonata Proto

The top half of the front face can be locked and hides the 5.25-inch bays and the power/reset buttons. There are only two thumb screws on the left hand side panel which can be locked with the help of a key. This prevents an unauthorised person from opening your cabinet.

The all-metal body has sharp edges. Specially the 3.5in HDD bays. Although they are the click-lock types, but since they are made of metal you have to be doubly careful around its edges. Also the 3.5in bays are located very close to the front wall such that your finger will get sandwiched between the clip and the front edge.

₹4,001 – ₹7,000

NZXT Guardian 921RB

This was one of the most well-designed cabinets that we tested and the only one with connection ports on the side. The Guardian has a definite head section, a body and the base. The three slits forming a Y shape get illuminated when the system is on. The head portion has an LCD readout of temperatures of the components inside. This feature was quite interesting and adds a professional touch to the cabinet. The front frame door opens to reveal three 5.25-inch bays and two 3.5-inch bays along with a fan at the base.

The side panel looks quite attractive with its designer window which holds a fan in the centre. This portion tends to bend easily under minor pressure. The HDD can be lodged with the help of two plastic rails and nails at strategic positions to lock the HDD. With an

Zebronics Aviator

Despite its compact size, our board fit in perfectly. Once again though not much room to manoeuvre around. The HDD bay has no clip lock system. The HDD has to be placed with the SATA ports coming out towards the side of the motherboard. So if you want to add a card, one bay will have to be sacrificed.

We like the two fans on the side panel which can be manually controlled with a switch. Also this is one of the few boards that has support for an SD card reader.

Cooler Master Elite 430 Black

CM Elite 430 Black is a simple looking case with a black plastic frame covering the 120mm fan behind the mesh and opening out to show the 3.5-inch and 5.25-inch bays. The front panel is removable and has dust filters around